

The Furman Multicultural Dance Society Constitution

Article 1: Name

The formal name of this organization shall be the Furman multicultural Dance Society.

Article 2: Purpose

The purpose of the Furman Multicultural Dance Society is to offer a space for students to discover the beauty and fun of the art of a variety of dances. The Furman Multicultural Dance Society will both bring dance to campus to encourage students to explore styles they may never have heard of before and invite students off-campus to join in dance with local communities.

Article 3: Affiliations

The Furman Multicultural Dance Society is not affiliated with any on-campus departments or off-campus organizations.

Article IV: Membership

Membership is open to any student who is interested in joining

In keeping with Furman University's non-discrimination policies, membership shall be open to all undergraduate, day students. Our organization will not discriminate on the basis of race, sex, handicap, age, sexual orientation, political affiliation, or religious affiliation

Article V: Officers

There will be traditional leadership offices such as President, Treasurer, and Secretary and Vice President offices based on the dances students are interested in. For example, there may be a Vice President of Swing Dancing, a Vice President of Latin Dance, etc.

The qualifications to serve as an officer are having experienced one dance event and holding a GPA of 2.5 or higher. Office is held from August of the academic year to the following May with roles changing over at final exams.

Article VI: Advisor

What is the general relationship of the advisor to the organization

Article VII: Meetings

Meetings are held at least once a month with additional meetings held as there is interest. Meetings will generally entail coordination of dances for the coming month as well as recap of the previous month to continue improving the experience for students.

Article VIII: Finance

The Furman Multicultural Dance Society is funded via the Furman Student Government Organization.

Article IX: Amendments

Amendment to the Constitution requires two-thirds of the officers to be in agreement and a meeting to be held open to general members to discuss the proposed changes and receive feedback.

Bylaws

Article I: Membership

There are no categories or requirements of membership. Membership is open to anyone and each member has equal standing with the next. In order to join the Furman Multicultural Dance Society, one must simply ask-- there is no application or selection process. Records will be kept of who participates in events, but for the purposes of tracking interest and identifying individuals for possible leadership positions.

In order to remove a member, the officers must discuss and vote two-thirds in favor of discussion with a staff member from Student Involvement and Inclusion to discuss whether or not removal is deemed appropriate. If deemed appropriate, the president and at least one other officer must meet with the member to inform of the removal.

Article II: Selection of Officers

Officers are selected by vote of the general members in April of each year. The individuals who win the majority for each position win that position. If there is a student who would like to create a new position for a new form of dance to add to the organization's offerings, the current officers must vote on accepting that person as a new Vice President along with there being at least 5 general members interested in participating in the new form of dance.

Roles of office:

The President functions as the general organizer for the group. The President presides over officer meetings and helps to oversee the smooth function of the group. The President is responsible ultimately for the actions of the organization.

The Treasurer manages the organization budget and communicates budget requests to the Student Government Association on behalf of the organization. The Treasurer is accountable to both the Student Government Association and the organization itself for keeping accurate records of finances.

The Secretary is responsible for keeping numbers on who attends each event and sending out reminders via email/GroupMe for students to know about upcoming events. The Secretary will also assist with any form of social media and advertising through flyers on campus.

All of the Vice Presidents are responsible for coordinating events for specific genres of dance. For example, the Vice President of Contra Dancing will find out about dances in the area and provide and coordinate when a group goes.

If there is a vacancy of office, then a general announcement will be sent out to members about the vacancy for a volunteer to fill it for the remainder of the term of office. If multiple people volunteer then they can either agree to collaborate on the role or put it to a vote of members.

If an officer needs to be removed from office, it will require meeting with a staff member from Student Involvement and Inclusion. This staff member and at least two officers will meet with the officer to be removed to talk about the removal. This process may only happen if all of the officers besides the one to be removed are in agreement.

Article III: Selection of Advisor

The advisor must be agreed upon by all officers and will be presented to the general members. Suggestions may be taken but ultimately the officers vote on the choice.

If an advisor needs to be removed, all of the officers must be in agreement and the entire group of officers must meet with a staff member from the office of Student Involvement and Inclusion to discuss the issues. If after that meeting it is still deemed appropriate to remove the advisor, the advisor will be asked to meet with the officers and staff member.

Article IV: Committees

The basic committees are based around dance events and will be formed informally based on the needs of the Vice Presidents. Committees will keep an eye out in the community for dances within the committee genre and will report these back and plan groups of students to go to these events if there is interest. Committees will also work to plan events on campus that fall under their committee headings. There will be no long-standing committees.

Article V: Rules of Order

Business will be informal with the Secretary keeping track of key details that everyone should know or be reminded of. Meetings will be held once a month and are not obligatory for membership.

Internal conflicts will be resolved by bringing the matter to the President who will discuss with involved parties and use conflict resolution techniques to find a solution that fits everyone.

Article VI: Amendments

In order to amend this constitution, members must be notified of planned changes and given time to submit feedback. Members are given the chance to vote. For an amendment to pass, a simple majority of general members and a two-thirds majority of officers is required.